SUB-CREATOR PAID

FREE GUIDE · KEYWORD SUBSTACK

Paid newsletter fees

Substack vs Patreon vs Ko-fi, with an example month

Substack

- 10% of paid subscription revenue + Stripe (~2.9% + $0.30).
- $5/month subscriber: you keep about $4.05.

Compared

- Patreon: 10% platform fee for new creators + processing.
- Ko-fi: 0% on tips; 5% on shop/memberships on the free plan, 0% on Gold ($12/month).

Example

- 100 paid readers × $4.05 ≈ $405/month before tax (example only).

Your next 3 steps

1. Start a free newsletter (beehiiv or Substack).
2. Send one useful issue every week.
3. Ask readers what they'd pay for before switching on paid.

Tool for this: beehiiv
subcreatorpaid.com/go/beehiiv (affiliate link: we may earn a commission at no cost to you)

Not sure which income stream fits you?
Try the free AI Income Finder: subcreatorpaid.com/#finder

Sources

- SchoolMaker: Substack pricing (Sep 2026): https://schoolmaker.com/blog/substack-pricing
- Patreon: standard platform fee for new creators: https://support.patreon.com/hc/en-us/articles/36426991446797
- SchoolMaker: Ko-fi pricing (Sep 2026): https://schoolmaker.com/blog/ko-fi-pricing

Pay figures are ranges or labelled examples, not promises. Rules change: check each official page before you start. From the video "Paid newsletter on Substack: what you keep". subcreatorpaid.com